NAME

ovn-ic-nb – OVN_IC_Northbound database schema

This database is the interface for cloud management system (CMS), such as OpenStack, to configure OVN interconnection settings. The CMS produces almost all of the contents of the database. The **ovn−ic** program monitors the database contents, transforms it, and stores it into the **OVN_IC_Southbound** database.

We generally speak of ''the'' CMS, but one can imagine scenarios in which multiple CMSes manage different parts of OVN interconnection.

External IDs

Each of the tables in this database contains a special column, named **external_ids**. This column has the same form and purpose each place it appears.

external_ids: map of string-string pairs
: Key-value pairs for use by the CMS. The CMS might use certain pairs, for example, to identify entities in its own configuration that correspond to those in this database.

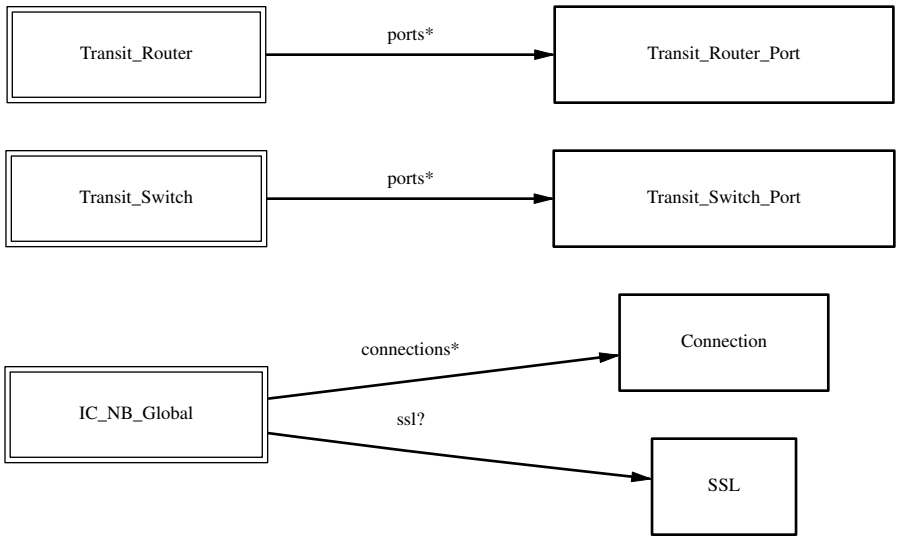
TABLE SUMMARY

The following list summarizes the purpose of each of the tables in the **OVN_IC_Northbound** database. Each table is described in more detail on a later page.

Table	Purpose
IC_NB_Global	IC Northbound configuration
Transit_Switch	Transit logical switch
Transit_Router	Transit logical router
Transit_Router_Port	Transit logical router
Transit_Switch_Port	Transit logical switch port
SSL	SSL configuration.
Connection	OVSDB client connections.

TABLE RELATIONSHIPS

The following diagram shows the relationship among tables in the database. Each node represents a table. Tables that are part of the ‘‘root set’’ are shown with double borders. Each edge leads from the table that contains it and points to the table that its value represents. Edges are labeled with their column names, followed by a constraint on the number of allowed values: **?** for zero or one, ***** for zero or more, **+** for one or more. Thick lines represent strong references; thin lines represent weak references.



IC_NB_Global TABLE

Northbound configuration for OVN interconnection. This table must have exactly one row.

Summary:

Status:	
nb_ic_cfg	integer
sb_ic_cfg	integer
Common Columns:	
external_ids	map of string-string pairs
Common options:	
options	map of string-string pairs
options : ic-backoff-interval-ms	optional string
options : ic_probe_interval	optional string
options : vxlan_mode	optional string
Connection Options:	
connections	set of **Connection**s
ssl	optional **SSL**

Details:

Status:

These columns allow a client to track the overall configuration state of the system.

nb_ic_cfg: integer

Sequence number for client to increment. When a client modifies the interconnect northbound database configuration and wishes to wait for **OVN−ICs** to handle this change and update the Interconnect southbound database, it may increment this sequence number.

sb_ic_cfg: integer

Sequence number that one **OVN−IC** sets to the value of **nb_ic_cfg** after waiting to all the **OVN−ICs** finish applying their changes to interconnect southbound database.

Common Columns:

external_ids: map of string-string pairs

See **External IDs** at the beginning of this document.

Common options:

options: map of string-string pairs

This column provides general key/value settings. The supported options are described individually below.

options : ic-backoff-interval-ms: optional string

Upper bound, in milliseconds, on how long **ovn−ic** postpones the next run of its incremental-processing engine. After each engine run, the next run is delayed by the duration of the run that just finished, capped by this value. This coalesces bursts of change-driven runs into fewer, larger runs, trading a small amount of latency for reduced CPU usage when the databases are changing rapidly.

This throttling only applies to the natural, change-driven incremental path. A forced full recompute is never delayed and always runs immediately.

The default value is **0**, which disables the backoff so each run is scheduled as soon as there is work to do.

options : ic_probe_interval: optional string

The inactivity probe interval of the connection to the OVN IC Northbound and Southbound databases from **ovn−ic**, in milliseconds. If the value is zero, it disables the connection keepalive feature.

If the value is nonzero, then it will be forced to a value of at least 1000 ms.

options : vxlan_mode: optional string
This field allows the client to enable VXLAN as encapsulation protocol for for cross-AZ traffic. Default value is false.

Connection Options:

connections: set of **Connection**s
Database clients to which the Open vSwitch database server should connect or on which it should listen, along with options for how these connections should be configured. See the **Connection** table for more information.

ssl: optional **SSL**
Global SSL/TLS configuration.

Transit_Switch TABLE

Each row represents one transit logical switch for interconnection between different OVN deployments (availability zones).

Summary:

Naming:

name	string (must be unique within table)
ports	set of **Transit_Switch_Port**s

Common Columns:

other_config	map of string-string pairs
external_ids	map of string-string pairs

Details:

Naming:

name: string (must be unique within table)
: A name that uniquely identifies the transit logical switch.

ports: set of **Transit_Switch_Port**s
: The transit switch's **Transit_Switch_Port** ports.

Common Columns:

other_config: map of string-string pairs

external_ids: map of string-string pairs
: See **External IDs** at the beginning of this document.

Transit_Router TABLE

Each row represents one transit logical router for interconnection between different OVN deployments (availability zones).

Summary:

Naming:

name	string (must be unique within table)
ports	set of **Transit_Router_Port**s

Common Columns:

other_config	map of string-string pairs
external_ids	map of string-string pairs

Details:

Naming:

name: string (must be unique within table)
: A name that uniquely identifies the transit logical router.

ports: set of **Transit_Router_Port**s
: The router's ports.

Common Columns:

other_config: map of string-string pairs

external_ids: map of string-string pairs
: See **External IDs** at the beginning of this document.

Transit_Router_Port TABLE

Each row represents one transit logical router for interconnection between different OVN deployments (availability zones).

Summary:

Naming:	
name	string (must be unique within table)
mac	string
chassis	string
tr_uuid	uuid
networks	set of strings
Common Columns:	
other_config	map of string-string pairs

Details:

Naming:

name: string (must be unique within table)

A name that uniquely identifies the transit logical router port.

mac: string

The Ethernet address that belongs to this router port.

chassis: string

The chassis this router port should be bound to. If empty, the port is local to all availability zones, that is, every availability zone instantiates it as a distributed router port of its own copy of the transit router. This is useful for ports that connect a transit router to a transit switch.

tr_uuid: uuid

This is the UUID of the northbound IC logical datapath this port is associated with.

networks: set of strings

The IP addresses and netmasks of the router port. For example, **192.168.0.1/24** indicates that the router's IP address is 192.168.0.1 and that packets destined to 192.168.0.*x* should be routed to this port. These are optional.

A logical router port always adds a link-local IPv6 address (fe80::/64) automatically generated from the interface's MAC address using the modified EUI–64 format.

Common Columns:

other_config: map of string-string pairs

Transit_Switch_Port TABLE

Each row represents one transit logical switch port for interconnection between different OVN deployments (availability zones).

Summary:

Naming:	
name	string (must be unique within table)
type	string
chassis	string
peer	string
addresses	set of strings
Common Columns:	
other_config	map of string-string pairs
external_ids	map of string-string pairs

Details:

Naming:

name: string (must be unique within table)
: A name that uniquely identifies the transit logical switch port.

type: string
: The type of the port. Set to **router** for a port connected to a logical router, or leave empty for a VIF port.

chassis: string
: The chassis this switch port should be bound to. If empty, the port is local to all availability zones.

peer: string
: The name of the peer logical router port, used when **type** is **router**.

addresses: set of strings
: The addresses associated with this port.

Common Columns:

other_config: map of string-string pairs

external_ids: map of string-string pairs

SSL TABLE

SSL/TLS configuration for ovn-nb database access.

Summary:

private_key	string
certificate	string
ca_cert	string
bootstrap_ca_cert	boolean
ssl_protocols	string
ssl_ciphers	string
ssl_ciphersuites	string
Common Columns:	
external_ids	map of string-string pairs

Details:

private_key: string

Name of a PEM file containing the private key used as the switch's identity for SSL/TLS connections to the controller.

certificate: string

Name of a PEM file containing a certificate, signed by the certificate authority (CA) used by the controller and manager, that certifies the switch's private key, identifying a trustworthy switch.

ca_cert: string

Name of a PEM file containing the CA certificate used to verify that the switch is connected to a trustworthy controller.

bootstrap_ca_cert: boolean

If set to **true**, then Open vSwitch will attempt to obtain the CA certificate from the controller on its first SSL/TLS connection and save it to the named PEM file. If it is successful, it will immediately drop the connection and reconnect, and from then on all SSL/TLS connections must be authenticated by a certificate signed by the CA certificate thus obtained. **This option exposes the SSL/TLS connection to a man−in−the−middle attack obtaining the initial CA certificate.** It may still be useful for bootstrapping.

ssl_protocols: string

Range or a comma- or space-delimited list of the SSL/TLS protocols to enable for SSL/TLS connections.

Supported protocols include **TLSv1.2** and **TLSv1.3**. Ranges can be provided in a form of two protocol names separated with a dash (**TLSv1.2−TLSv1.3**), or as a single protocol name with a plus sign (**TLSv1.2+**). The value can be a list of protocols or exactly one range. The range is a preferred way of specifying protocols and the configuration always behaves as if the range between the minimum and the maximum specified version is provided, i.e., if the value is set to **TLSv1.X,TLSv1.(X+2)**, the **TLSv1.(X+1)** will also be enabled as if it was a range. Regardless of order, the highest protocol supported by both sides will be chosen when making the connection.

The default when this option is omitted is **TLSv1.2+**.

ssl_ciphers: string

List of ciphers (in OpenSSL cipher string format) to be supported for SSL/TLS connections with TLSv1.2. The default when this option is omitted is **DEFAULT:@SECLEVEL=2**.

ssl_ciphersuites: string

List of ciphersuites (in OpenSSL ciphersuites string format) to be supported for SSL/TLS connections with TLSv1.3 and later. Default value from OpenSSL will be used when this option is omitted.

Common Columns:

The overall purpose of these columns is described under **Common Columns** at the beginning of this

document.

external_ids: map of string-string pairs

Connection TABLE

Configuration for a database connection to an Open vSwitch database (OVSDB) client.

This table primarily configures the Open vSwitch database server (**ovsdb−server**).

The Open vSwitch database server can initiate and maintain active connections to remote clients. It can also listen for database connections.

Summary:

Core Features:	
target	string (must be unique within table)
Client Failure Detection and Handling:	
max_backoff	optional integer, at least 1,000
inactivity_probe	optional integer
Status:	
is_connected	boolean
status : last_error	optional string
status : state	optional string, one of **ACTIVE**, **BACKOFF**, **CONNECTING**, **IDLE**, or **VOID**
status : sec_since_connect	optional string, containing an integer, at least 0
status : sec_since_disconnect	optional string, containing an integer, at least 0
status : locks_held	optional string
status : locks_waiting	optional string
status : locks_lost	optional string
status : n_connections	optional string, containing an integer, at least 2
status : bound_port	optional string, containing an integer
Common Columns:	
external_ids	map of string-string pairs
other_config	map of string-string pairs

Details:

Core Features:

target: string (must be unique within table)

Connection methods for clients.

The following connection methods are currently supported:

ssl:*host*[**:***port*]

The specified SSL/TLS *port* on the host at the given *host*, which can either be a DNS name (if built with unbound library) or an IP address. A valid SSL/TLS configuration must be provided when this form is used, this configuration can be specified via command-line options or the **SSL** table.

If *port* is not specified, it defaults to 6640.

SSL/TLS support is an optional feature that is not always built as part of OVN or Open vSwitch.

tcp:*host*[**:***port*]

The specified TCP *port* on the host at the given *host*, which can either be a DNS name (if built with unbound library) or an IP address. If *host* is an IPv6 address, wrap it in square brackets, e.g. **tcp:[::1]:6640**.

If *port* is not specified, it defaults to 6640.

pssl:[*port*][**:***host*]

Listens for SSL/TLS connections on the specified TCP *port*. Specify 0 for *port* to have the kernel automatically choose an available port. If *host*, which can either be a DNS name (if built with unbound library) or an IP address, is specified, then connections are restricted to

the resolved or specified local IPaddress (either IPv4 or IPv6 address). If *host* is an IPv6 address, wrap in square brackets, e.g. **pssl:6640:[::1]**. If *host* is not specified then it listens only on IPv4 (but not IPv6) addresses. A valid SSL/TLS configuration must be provided when this form is used, this can be specified either via command-line options or the **SSL** table.

If *port* is not specified, it defaults to 6640.

SSL/TLS support is an optional feature that is not always built as part of OVN or Open vSwitch.

ptcp:[*port*][**:***host*]
Listens for connections on the specified TCP *port*. Specify 0 for *port* to have the kernel automatically choose an available port. If *host*, which can either be a DNS name (if built with unbound library) or an IP address, is specified, then connections are restricted to the resolved or specified local IP address (either IPv4 or IPv6 address). If *host* is an IPv6 address, wrap it in square brackets, e.g. **ptcp:6640:[::1]**. If *host* is not specified then it listens only on IPv4 addresses.

If *port* is not specified, it defaults to 6640.

When multiple clients are configured, the **target** values must be unique. Duplicate **target** values yield unspecified results.

Client Failure Detection and Handling:

max_backoff: optional integer, at least 1,000
Maximum number of milliseconds to wait between connection attempts. Default is implementation-specific.

inactivity_probe: optional integer
Maximum number of milliseconds of idle time on connection to the client before sending an inactivity probe message. If Open vSwitch does not communicate with the client for the specified number of seconds, it will send a probe. If a response is not received for the same additional amount of time, Open vSwitch assumes the connection has been broken and attempts to reconnect. Default is implementation-specific. A value of 0 disables inactivity probes.

Status:

Key-value pair of **is_connected** is always updated. Other key-value pairs in the status columns may be updated depends on the **target** type.

When **target** specifies a connection method that listens for inbound connections (e.g. **ptcp:** or **punix:**), both **n_connections** and **is_connected** may also be updated while the remaining key-value pairs are omitted.

On the other hand, when **target** specifies an outbound connection, all key-value pairs may be updated, except the above-mentioned two key-value pairs associated with inbound connection targets. They are omitted.

is_connected: boolean
true if currently connected to this client, **false** otherwise.

status : last_error: optional string
A human-readable description of the last error on the connection to the manager; i.e. **strerror(errno)**. This key will exist only if an error has occurred.

status : state: optional string, one of **ACTIVE**, **BACKOFF**, **CONNECTING**, **IDLE**, or **VOID**
The state of the connection to the manager:

VOID Connection is disabled.

BACKOFF
Attempting to reconnect at an increasing period.

CONNECTING
Attempting to connect.

ACTIVE
Connected, remote host responsive.

IDLE Connection is idle. Waiting for response to keep-alive.

These values may change in the future. They are provided only for human consumption.

status : sec_since_connect: optional string, containing an integer, at least 0
The amount of time since this client last successfully connected to the database (in seconds). Value is empty if client has never successfully been connected.

status : sec_since_disconnect: optional string, containing an integer, at least 0
The amount of time since this client last disconnected from the database (in seconds). Value is empty if client has never disconnected.

status : locks_held: optional string
Space-separated list of the names of OVSDB locks that the connection holds. Omitted if the connection does not hold any locks.

status : locks_waiting: optional string
Space-separated list of the names of OVSDB locks that the connection is currently waiting to acquire. Omitted if the connection is not waiting for any locks.

status : locks_lost: optional string
Space-separated list of the names of OVSDB locks that the connection has had stolen by another OVSDB client. Omitted if no locks have been stolen from this connection.

status : n_connections: optional string, containing an integer, at least 2
When **target** specifies a connection method that listens for inbound connections (e.g. **ptcp:** or **pssl:**) and more than one connection is actually active, the value is the number of active connections. Otherwise, this key-value pair is omitted.

status : bound_port: optional string, containing an integer
When **target** is **ptcp:** or **pssl:**, this is the TCP port on which the OVSDB server is listening. (This is particularly useful when **target** specifies a port of 0, allowing the kernel to choose any available port.)

Common Columns:

The overall purpose of these columns is described under **Common Columns** at the beginning of this document.

external_ids: map of string-string pairs

other_config: map of string-string pairs